[LIT-FLK-006] Hangkho KhalÆngwui Khararchan

Translation: The Tale of the Boy Who Became a Hornbill

Work Type: FOLK_TALE | Creator: Tangkhul Oral Tradition Custodians | Year: 1981
Village: Phungcham | Dialect: Phungcham / Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-TLS-015
Publisher / Source: Tangkhul Literature Society / Documented in Arokia
Clearance: Traditional Oral Heritage | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Orphan adversity and cruelty of uncustomary stepmother (*Kashunao wui Khangaran*), Avian metamorphism and transformation into the Great

Structure & Meter: Ancestral mythological narrative in tri-partite tragic meter with rhyt

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Critical Overview: One of the most famous and deeply poignant folktales in the Tangkhul canon. It warns community members against the mistreatment of

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Kashunao mayarnao Hangkho akha pamlaga, akhava eina ava kathinao-wui van
Chitharan ava-nganungna khamakhei shimchin pida, sangkhor-li pamkakhung
Iramwui vanao kachiphun thada iwui khamahon horkhava ningungda, akhan ak
Phungcham ramwui khararchar-li vanao-wui khon sakakhung eina, 'Hangkho-n
Mei-ngaleili kapam mayarnao Hangkho, kazingramwui mashon phaphakhavai kh
Chiwui thada kachamnao mayarnao Hangkho khalÆngwui khon horkashung eina

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

In an ancient village lived the orphan boy Hangkho, who suffered endless
Treated harshly by his stepmother and relegated to the cold hearth, he w
Yearning to escape human torment like the free-flying birds of the alpin
Weaving wings of hornbill plumage, he climbed to the highest ridge of Ph
Leaving behind the earthly hearth and village sorrows, he spread his gre
Thus the orphan boy transformed into the majestic great hornbill, soarin

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Hangkho : Great Indian Hornbill (Buceros bicornis), symbol o
* KhalÆng : To soar, transform, take flight into avian form
* Kashunao : Orphan child, vulnerable without parental guardian

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